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ANSWERS : STIMULUS BASED MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. The ideas expressed in the excerpt best represent a continuation of which of the following 19th Century developments?

(A) Manifest Destiny	**Correct**: Turner's focus on the "frontier" indicates the continued push westward as the driving force behind "the forces dominating American character" and growth.
(B) Social Darwinism	**Incorrect**: Social Darwinism is not directly addressed in the excerpt.
(C) New Imperialism	**Incorrect**: New Imperialism would serve as a continuation of Manifest Destiny to close out the 19th and begin the 20th Century through the Spanish-American War.
(D) Sectionalism	**Incorrect**: Sectionalism, largely referring to regional economic differences and the slave debate, is not directly addressed in the excerpt.

2. All the following were effects of the development described in the excerpt except

(A) war with Spain to gain new island territories in the Caribbean and Pacific	**Incorrect**: Expansion abroad was the logical succession to westward continental expansion.
(B) enduring support for foreign independence movements	**Correct**: The Cuban, Filipino, and Panamanian struggles for independence are primary examples of American intervention motivated by national interests rather than enduring support for self-determination.
(C) increased competition for control of Asian and Latin American markets	**Incorrect**: Cracking into the spheres of influence dominating trade in China became a focus for American economic interests.
(D) domestic debates over America's changing role in the world	**Incorrect**: The debate between imperialist jingos and anti-imperialists raged on in the news media and Congress.

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3. Turner's mention of "the forces dominating American character" most likely refers to which of the following?

(A)	The self-sufficient and individualistic nature of the American pioneer	**Correct**: The American psyche began to venerate the figurative image of the white American pioneer on the western edge of civilization.
(B)	Principles of equality and freedom established in the United States' founding documents	**Incorrect**: The Declaration of Independence and the US Constitution are not mentioned or alluded to in the excerpt.
(C)	The supposed superiority of whites over other groups in American history	**Incorrect**: Though tacitly implied, race is not mentioned or alluded to in the excerpt.
(D)	The Union victory in the Civil War due to its industrial advantage	**Incorrect**: The Civil War, debate over slavery, or northern dominance is not mentioned or alluded to in the excerpt.

4. Which of the following developments most contributed to the conditions described in the excerpt?

(A)	Reform movements called for restrictions on corporations and trusts	**Incorrect**: Progressive reforms such as the Food and Drug Act and the creation of the Food and Drug Administration resulted from the outrage elicited by Sinclair's book.
(B)	Increased leverage afforded to workers through unionization	**Incorrect**: Labor unions sought to remedy the conditions described in the excerpt.
(C)	An influx of largely poor and unskilled immigrants	**Correct**: Despite union criticisms, a lack of concern for individual safety and working conditions on the part of factory owners emerged as sources of labor in the industrial workplace were seemingly never ending.
(D)	Corporate interests lobbying for favorable legislation	**Incorrect**: The conditions described in the excerpt resulted from industrialists prioritizing profit over the well-being of workers and the lack of regulations.

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5. Which of the following groups was not significantly affected by the conditions described in the excerpt?

(A) Immigrants from Europe	**Incorrect**: Lacking alternative economic opportunities, European immigrants (especially from Southern and Eastern Europe) became the dominant labor source in industrial meatpacking plants and factories during the early 20th Century.
(B) Women in northern cities	**Incorrect**: Compared to previous eras, women contributed to the industrial labor force in a substantial way.
(C) Children from working class families	**Incorrect**: Child labor became a hot button issue during the Progressive Era as poor urban families enlisted their children's help to make ends meet.
(D) African Americans in the South	**Correct**: While industrialization continued to take root in the South, the conditions described in the excerpt dominated the Midwestern and Northern industrial landscape whereas sharecropping dominated the South.

6. Which of the following best describes the goals of authors and journalists like Upton Sinclair?

(A) Make the public and lawmakers aware of corruption and inequality in the United States	**Correct**: Muckrakers aimed to bring awareness to the public of the rampant corruption and inequality that existed, primarily in urban centers. They were criticized by economic and political forces as subversive to their goals and as a negative force in society.
(B) Inform workers and minorities of their rights and encourage activism	**Incorrect**: Activism was encouraged by muckrakers but it was not the primary goal.
(C) Completely dismantle and abolish large corporations and trusts	**Incorrect**: Muckrakers knew that the power to bring about the end to trusts was not in their hands. Thus, mobilizing voters to bring about change was the larger focus.

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(D)	Exaggerate the problems in society to increase circulation of their publications	**Incorrect**: Muckrakers operated in the realm of investigative journalism and honest fiction. Sensationalism was reserved for the larger "yellow" journalistic publications.

7. The trends depicted in the image resulted most directly from which of the following factors?

(A)	The invention of mass production methods including the assembly line	**Incorrect**: Methods of mass production had been churning out products for decades. The assembly line was invented almost a decade prior to the information presented in the image.
(B)	Cheaper raw materials from new territories and markets	**Incorrect**: Most materials used in American-made products were sourced from within the country at this time.
(C)	Outsourced labor to Asia and Latin America for lower wages	**Incorrect**: Commercial products sold in America were still largely produced in America during the first half of the 20th Century.
(D)	Consumerist culture and the ability to pay on installment plans	**Correct**: Consumerism took society by storm in the 1920s as buying on credit expanded the purchasing power of the American public.

8. Improved communication methods connecting the country contributed to all of the following except

(A)	Greater awareness of regional identities	**Incorrect**: Regional identities did become more apparent to those outside their particular region, including that of blacks in the North through the Harlem Renaissance.
(B)	Increased economic productivity	**Incorrect**: Communication technologies increased the efficiency of business, thus increasing economic productivity.
(C)	Spread of a national culture	**Incorrect**: Mainstream, or popular, culture was a new phenomenon that reached new heights in the 1920s due to the widespread use of radios, telephones, and motion pictures.

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(D) Rapid decline of nativism and racism	**Correct**: Nativism and racism also reached new heights during the 1920s as skepticism of immigrants grew out of concern for communism influencing the United States as well as the continued oppression and terrorizing of blacks during the Jim Crow era.

9. Which of the following best represents the conditions to which the poster was responding to?

(A) Ineffectiveness of early New Deal policies	**Incorrect**: Most relief efforts in the first months of the New Deal were largely successful. Banks were revived, farms bounced back, and unemployment decreased.
(B) Economic crisis due to market instability and bank failures	**Correct**: President Roosevelt's New Deal was directly responding to the Great Depression, set off by a farming depression and stock market crash in the 1920s. This led to a "run" on the banks, leading to widespread bank closures.
(C) Decline in international trade throughout the 1920s	**Incorrect**: While a decline in international trade did contribute to the economic crisis of the 1930s, the New Deal was not directly responding to a global situation.
(D) Overspending on new goods by American consumers	**Incorrect**: Buying on credit also contributed to the growing stock market "bubble". However, the New Deal initially aimed to address the immediate effects of the Great Depression.

10. Which of the following groups would most likely disagree with the poster?

(A) Conservative Republicans	**Correct**: Conservatives, including Herbert Hoover and many on the Supreme Court bench, viewed much of the New Deal as a socialist overreach of federal power.

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(B) President Franklin Roosevelt	**Inorrect**: FDR served as the impetus behind the New Deal, embracing Keynesian economic philosophy in order to stimulate the national economy.
(C) Midwestern farmers	**Incorrect**: Coupled with the Dust Bowl, farmers in the Great Plains region were the hardest hit by the Great Depression and sought new economic opportunities across the country.
(D) members of the Democratic Party	**Incorrect**: The "Big Tent" party of FDR largely supported his New Deal efforts. Some even criticised the New Deal as not going far enough to provide relief to the unemployed and impoverished.

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